GOVERNMENT COLLEGE IBADAN
OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION 1986 SET



ANNIVERSARY REUNION

DINNER & AWARD NIGHT

16TH OCTOBER, 2026

6PM PROMPT

AT FUNCTION HALL, **JOGOR CENTER**, IBADAN.

FOR ENQUIRIES:

CONTACT GCI '86 EXCO

CLASS OF 86

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

GOVERNMENT COLLEGE IBADAN – OLD BOYS' ASSOCIATION

THE PROGRAMME

1. Opening Prayer
2. National Anthem/School Song
3. Introduction of Guests
4. Set Chairman Message — Seun Esho
5. Keynote Speaker
6. Swanston & Grier School Song
7. Presentation of Awards — Charles Olayinka
8. Sing Song I
9. Field, Powell and Carr School Song
10. Reading of Some Memoirs
11. Moment of Silence for Fallen Boys
12. Sing Song II
13. Cutting of the Cake
14. Pictures
15. Vote of Thanks — Kolade Aladeojebi
16. Dance , Dance, Dance

CHAIRMAN'S MESSAGE

Dear Fellow Alumni, Friends, and Distinguished Guests,

Welcome to our 40th Anniversary Gala Night!

At the beginning of my tenure, our primary mission was clear: to execute projects with direct, meaningful impacts on students and the dedicated staff—both academic and non-academic—who keep our school running.

Tonight, as we reflect on four decades of bond and brotherhood, I am filled with gratitude for what we have accomplished together:

Empowering the Next Generation: Through our ICT Project (Project X) and our ICT Summer Camp, we equipped students with vital modern tech skills. We hosted impactful Career Fairs (Supported by Google) to give our pupils the knowledge, direction, and practical skills needed for life after school.

Honouring Our Heroes: We established recognition programs, awards, and rewards to celebrate the hard work and selfless service of both academic and non-academic staff.

Fostering Health & Fellowship: We promoted sportsmanship through various athletic events, including our recent Table Tennis Tournament.

Sustaining the Future: Above all, we brought to life our flagship initiative—the Young Farmers' Club (YFC) & Farm Project—igniting passion and introducing our students to modern agricultural practices.

None of these achievements would have been possible without your unwavering support, generous contributions, and shared passion. I extend my heartiest gratitude to every member of the set, EXCO, our L.O.C. and YFC team and our wonderful families for making this vision a reality.

Serving this class set has been one of the highest honours of my life.

Tonight is about celebrating our past, honouring our journey, and looking forward to an even brighter future. So, we raise a glass to 40 years of excellence, friendship, and impact!

'Seun Akin-Esho

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

GALLERY





















SCHOOL SONG

School of our pride built on the rock
By order, justice and fairplay ruled
May what we dare to learn from thee in youth
Be our guidelight throughout our lives

Refrain: School of our pride we build on thee

Service to others not to self
Consideration for our Nation first
By our examples and not by precept
Show honest labour's dignity

Refrain: School of our pride we build on thee

Generations shall come and go
But our pride you will for aye remain
Maybe not in the confines of your walls
But in Alumni world-renowned

Refrain: School of our pride we build on thee

Carr House

1. Where is the source of our great joy?
Everyday we're bound in joy
Our unique fruit of ambition
It's striking initiation
Comes from this lovely home of grace
Carr House historical place
All Eaglets let us now rejoie
An exalt Carr with our voice.

2. Of all eaglets none can deny
What pleasures he has thereby
To cheer up our hopeful course
Are provided games and sports
Thus boredom removed from our way
Never sad but always gay
We heartily thank Vigilia
May he help us for ever.

3. We all are very proud of thee
Something must we do for thee
Youngest yet envied by others
Present boys, let's lead others
Our Old Boys will take charge willingly
Of greater affairs bravely
Thus fulfilling their promises
Helping Carr House in all fields.

4. Great men will from Carr House emerge
Christ from Nazareth did emerge
Glorious things for thee shall we do
We honour that great crest too
Eagle, king to birds of all types
Indicates our place in life
Great was our Patron, Henry Carr

Field House

1. Foremost stands the sun in heaven
Foremost! Field House in this School
Field House is our inspiration
Past achievements show this well
Inspiration stirs ambition
Leads us unto better yet
Sixteen only when we started
Now unrivalled amongst the rest.

2. Those who left us showed our spirit
Standing well the test of life
Brave in sorrow, staunch in service
Field House lessons held in mind
In the face of strife and hardship
Holding on without despair
Their achievements are our glory
Their example is our guide.

3. Fieldiers present the calls now yours
Keep the noble flame alight
The name by which the flame was lit
Shall ne'r die. H.Field for aye
Don't forget what Baba Job taught
Valiant toil brings glorious name
Keep our glory and spirit
Evergreen and ever bright.

Grier House

1. O Grier House, let us for thy dear honour yearn
Let us from experience past this lesson learnt
That discipline leads but to our one true goal
Devotion, true must be our unfailing role.

2. We dare to learn both from victory and defeat
If once our best is done then we all can meet
To sing loud in praise of thy untarnished fame
That both past and present cherish just the same.

3. United in Spirit we uphold thy grace!
Of unbroken justice taught in every race
Grier sons thy true greatness must strive sure to shield
We dare to learn always and we 'll never yield.

Swanston House

Oh, Swanston House
The call, the call has come to you
To do your best to help this world along
To be like him who trod this earth before you
And died without a consciousness of wrong
But do not wait for idleness to injure you
Get up and work now that you've work to do
And when you win, be not proud nor conceited
But rest content with work well done
Oh Swanston House.

Powell House

1. From East and from West came we
To lodge in thee, royal host
Came to put life into thee
To make thee great is a must
What a house, it shines like as
Diamond among rough stones
We in you shall not be drones
We shall make you polished brass.

2. On the field or in the school
Towards evening or at noon
We shall employ every tool
That school glories may be won
Powell House is full of young blood
In the building, in the boys
It shall not be just our noise
But our trophy-tray must flood.

3. See the violet arise
Mustard seed mixed with the swan
Born a leader Powell is
From him, older brothers learn
Neatness, sports and discipline
Beautiful environment
From these our way'll not bend
And our glory never less.

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

RECOGNITION OF OUR DISTINGUISHED AWARDEES

As we celebrate the 40th Anniversary of the GCI 1986 Set, we pause to recognize and honor some of our distinguished classmates whose commitment, generosity, leadership, and service have contributed significantly to the success of this milestone celebration.

The journey to this 40th Anniversary has been made possible not only by the passage of time, but by the dedication of individuals who have continued to uphold the values of friendship, unity, service, leadership, and giving back—values instilled in us during our years at Government College Ibadan.

Today, we proudly recognize these distinguished awardees for their exceptional contributions and unwavering support.

Their contributions have extended beyond financial support. Through their leadership, encouragement, generosity, personal commitment, and willingness to serve, they have helped strengthen the bond among members of the 1986 Set and advance our collective vision of leaving a meaningful legacy for current and future generations of students.

We particularly acknowledge those who have supported our various anniversary initiatives, including the Young Farmers Club (YFC) project, school building renovation, and the 40th Anniversary Gala Night. Their contributions demonstrate that the true meaning of an anniversary is not simply to look back at where we came from, but to give back and make a positive difference in the lives of those who come after us.

These awardees represent the spirit of GCI 1986—brotherhood, excellence, service, and legacy.

On behalf of the entire GCI 1986 Set, we express our sincere gratitude and appreciation to each of you. Your names and contributions will forever remain an important part of the story of our 40th Anniversary.

Congratulations to all our distinguished awardees.

Forty Years Strong.
One Brotherhood.
One Legacy.
GCI 1986.



Thank You!
To All Our Donors

Eniola Odeniyi
Owoade Taiwo
Adegborioye Wole
Adelaja Adesanya
Seun Esho
Kolade Aladeojebi
Ayo Ajanaku
Olubowale Olukanmi
Charles Olayinka
Adekunle Adesope
Tunbi Ashaye
Lanre Olagbaju
Mojeed Okunola
Gbenga Ayeni
Taiwo Adepoju
Kehinde Adepoju
Niyi Omole
Demola Oyebade
Ashaolu Olubunmi
Dapo Aderibigbe
Adeniyi Gbadamosi
Olaniyi Cole
Mustapha Ayodeji
Bimbo Oladapo
Seyi Taiwo
Akinlosotu Tunde
Wale Ojoawo
Akano Sumbo
Kola Majaro

Muyiwa Momoh
Louis Omoyine
Tolu Makinde
Oluyemi Yinka
Falode Bayo
Senaike Yemi
Eniola Tunde
Adewole Wole
Adesipe Wale
Julius Raphael
Olaleye Olamide
Obasa Adedapo
Adesuyi Olusegun
Deji Atoyebi
Yemi Segun
Fola Agoro
Akinsola Owoyomi
Kelvin Owolabi
Abimbola Adeniji
Kehinde Siwoku
Akinloye Alashoadura
Frederick Oshinowo
Jide Oyeniyi
Adedeji Abdullajeel
Armstrong Ayiegbeni
Adebola Adegbite
Afolabi Ogun
GCIOBA 1985 Set

Kola Orejimi
Gbenga Odumesi
Sunday Balogun
Oluwatele Sekoni
Muyiwa Ayanola
Adedotun Adekunle
Femi Olaobaju
Tolu Adigun
Yimika Oshikanlu
Kayode Olugbodi
Demola Atanda
Bolaji Ajao
Olayemi Ojewale
Timilehin Akhigbe
Seun Olutola
Ogun Sunday
Wole Ogunleye
Nofiu Soremekun
Wale Adesipe
Akinwale Ojoawo
Olusegun Ogundiran
Atilade Adeleke
Ademola Ojetunji
Lanre Ranti-Olubi
Olanrewaju Bolarin
Olaniyi Olaobaju
Segun Onabajo
Oluwaseun Onatade

GOVERNMENT COLLEGE IBADAN
OLD BOYS ASSOCIATION 1986 SET

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

DINNER & AWARD NIGHT

GCI EXPERIENCE MEMOIRS

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

MEMOIRS



GOVERNMENT COLLEGE IBADAN, TRULY A CITADEL OF INTELLECTUALISM.

Coming from a family of GCI alumni, my father and elder brothers having passed through same school, I was already looking forward to getting in.

From a public primary school background where i experienced some levels of leadership training as a 'small boy' to the prestigious Government College, Ibadan as a 'GCI boy', what i experienced through the 6 years of learning cannot be overemphasized.

Dedicated teachers, wonderful classmates with diverse backgrounds and gifts, school environment that breathes purpose, possibilities and prosperity, a school song that is thought-provoking with deep insights, not to forget 'dramas', i joined the league of expectant boys with limitless success expectations.

GCI developed my intellectual, social, interpersonal, competitive, communication, people management and moral skills to mention a few. It opened me up to healthy competition, real-life scenarios, 'street-sense' and deep integrity.

As HOS (Head of School), my people management and public speaking skills were developed. I spoke to intellectuals and captains of industry as a teenager. This exposure still resonates with me up till now. It was an unforgettable experience.

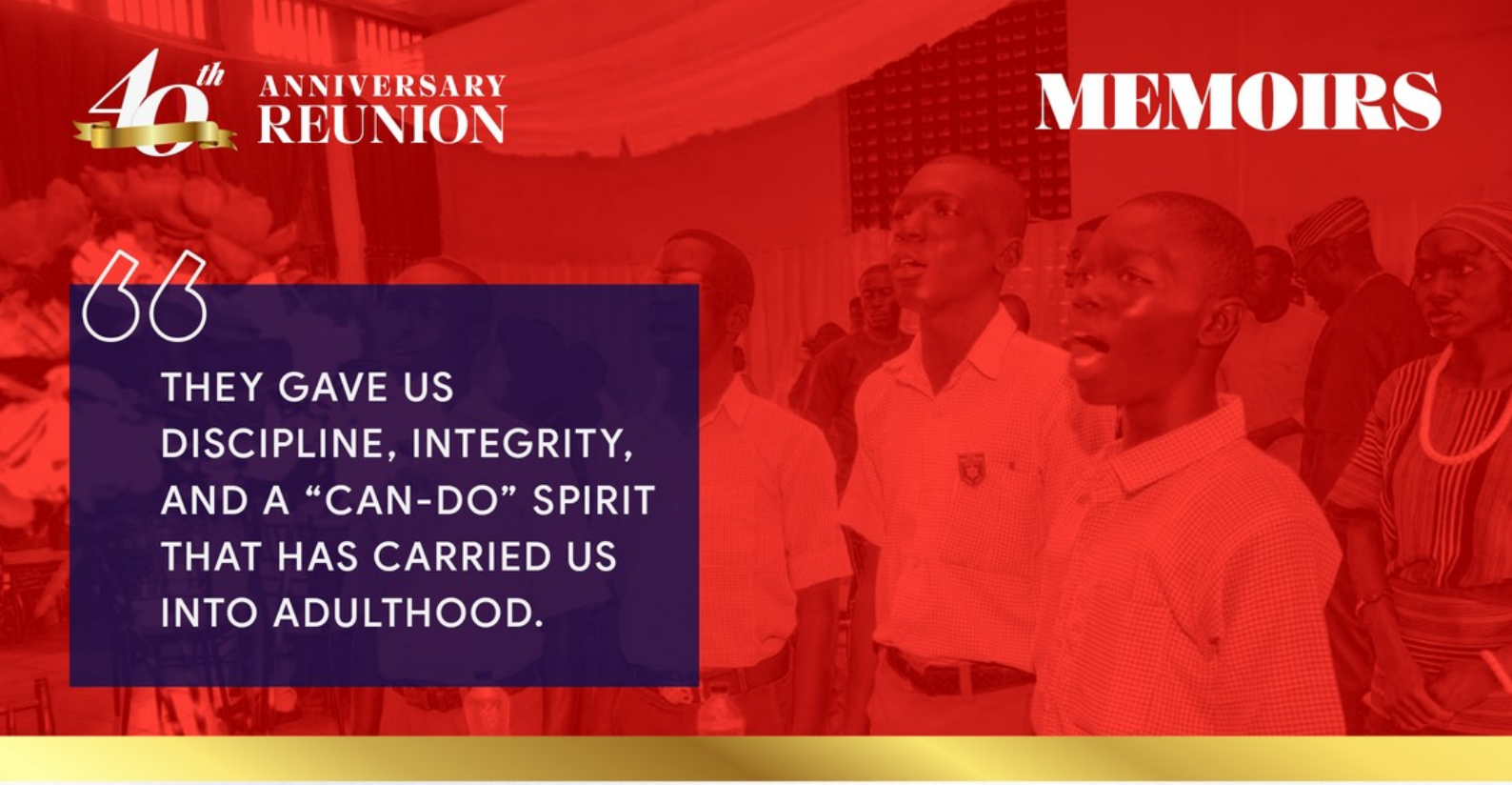
GCI made me to know that a responsible boy must be physically wholesome, mentally stimulating, morally satisfying and socially sound. GCI boys are known for integrity and diligence.

With the so many great GCI boys out there, we were exposed to them through the annual GCIOBA reunions, a programme that must never be stopped. It gave us hope, ideas and needed drive to go above and beyond with a confidence that is unstoppable.

No matter our age or the country we find ourselves in, the mere mention of our GCI nickname in a public space instantly rekindles the camaraderie of the great Government College, Ibadan.

Up School!!!!!!!!!!!!

ADETUNBI ASHAYE
School No: 6242; Grier House



> THEY GAVE US DISCIPLINE, INTEGRITY, AND A "CAN-DO" SPIRIT THAT HAS CARRIED US INTO ADULTHOOD.

Distinguished guests, esteemed Old Boys, ladies and gentlemen,

Good evening. It feels wonderful to be here — surrounded by people who survived the same buttery rush, the same morning assembly drills, and the same legendary Aba Dele adventures. If you're here tonight, it means you made it through GCI with your dignity mostly intact... and your sense of humor fully developed.

My own journey began in 1986. I walked through the gates of Government College Ibadan with my shoulders squared and my head held high — not because I was confident, but because I didn't want seniors to think I was an easy target. I had just been admitted into the most prestigious secondary school I could imagine. My uncles, proud Old Boys, had filled my head with stories of excellence, discipline, and greatness. They conveniently left out the stories about punishments, chores, and the creative ways seniors could make you "run errands."

But still, I came in determined to make my mark.

And oh, the memories. Selling mangoes from my backyard to learn commercial acumen — because GCI taught entrepreneurship long before it became fashionable. Representing the school at the JETS competition — where we were convinced we were the smartest boys in Nigeria, even if our inventions sometimes looked like they were held together with hope and masking tape.

Then there were the social events, the house rivalries, and of course, Aba Dele — the place where many of us perfected the art of mischief. If those walls could talk, they would probably demand hazard pay.

I remember being the best student in Literature and English Language in my year — a fact I like to remind my children of whenever they try to correct my grammar. And I remember early morning

conversations with Kunle Oduntan, Tunji Alese, Tunbi Ashaye and others — conversations where we solved maths problems, chemistry equations, and occasionally, the mystery of who finished the last bail in the buttery.

But truly, the heart of GCI was the teachers. Giants. Legends. People who could look at you and know instantly whether you had done your homework or were just pretending to be deep in thought. Mr. Tutu Adegun, Mr. Shriharan, Mr. Sivasubrahmanian, Mrs. Ibitoye — they didn't just teach us; they shaped us. They gave us discipline, integrity, and a "can-do" spirit that has carried us into adulthood.

Those values have taken some of us across the world — in my case, through 4 continents of the world and currently to Abu Dhabi as a Senior Drilling Engineer with ADNOC — yet no matter how far we go, GCI remains home.

Tonight, as we celebrate, we honor every lecture, every punishment, every friendship, every victory, and yes, every mischief. Because all of it made us who we are.

Government College Ibadan is not just a school. It is a heritage. A brotherhood. A place that turned boys into men — and gave us stories we still laugh about decades later.

Generations shall come and go, but our pride in this institution will forever remain.

Up School! Up Maroon!

AKINTUNDE OLANIYI AKINLOSOTU
School No: 6238; Grier House
Senior Drilling Engineer,
Abu Dhabi National Oil Company – Onshore,
Abu Dhabi, UAE.



BIGGER THAN A SCHOOL!

The pleasant smell of freshly mown lawns at Government College Ibadan revealed to me that I had entered a whole new world. During the first few days of registration, I was eager for my mum to leave me to myself because I did not want to be seen as a "mummy's boy" by my older childhood friends who were already my seniors.

What fascinated me most as a fresh student were the scenery, the military cadet parade, the ceremonial shirt, trousers and tie, the school and respective house songs, the sports—especially the vintage game of cricket—the Old Boys' Association culture and traditions, the confidence radiated by the students, and so much more.

Unconsciously, these fascinations became some of the very things that moulded me into the person I am today.

During my undergraduate years studying Architecture, a lecturer once asked me why I was so elaborate and extensive with my landscape designs. I replied, "Buildings are hard, so they need to be simple, while landscapes are soft, so they have to be complex."

He then asked, "Which secondary school did you attend?"

"Government College Ibadan, Sir," I replied.

He shook his head and simply said, "Say no more!"

It was at that moment that I realised something profound had been instilled in me by my alma mater.

Similarly, I have had several experiences during work presentations where I have been asked the familiar questions, and my answer would immediately satisfy their curiosity. Some have even gone as far as asking whether we were taught "confidence" as a separate subject at GCI.

However, the greatest influence GCI has had on me is the spiritual sense of association that comes with being an Old Boy.

Among the many experiences I have had, one remains unforgettable.

I once saw some elderly gentlemen at a country club throwing banter at one another and reminiscing about their days as students of GCI. I immediately stood up and approached their table to greet them as “My Teurs,” in our traditional manner.

They embraced me, practically snatched me away from my host, and insisted that I sit with them for the duration of my stay at the club.

The epic moment came when I excused myself to use the restroom. On my way out, I ran into a gentleman who had been observing my encounters with these Old Boys.

He looked at me and asked innocently, “Excuse me, sir, is that GCI Old Boys’ Association a cult?”

It took all my composure not to burst out laughing, as I did not want to appear rude to him. After a moment, I calmly responded:

“No, sir. GCI is not a cult. But it is bigger than a school.”

ADELEKE ATILADE ’86
School No: 6289
Field House



MEMOIRS

> IT IS WONDERFUL CELEBRATING OUR 40TH ANNIVERSARY OF OUR ADMISSION INTO GCI.

MEMOIR OF A SCHOOL BOY

I got admitted into Form 1 Government College Ibadan in 1986.

I knew I came-in late to school by two days, I discovered that the school had already started the orientation programme (a week long programme made compulsory for the new intakes) which allows them to learn the history and traditions of GCI.

With my white shirt and khaki shorts I proceeded to the Assembly Hall, the first person I sat with was later known as Femi Adedayo he was eating this white powdery substance which I later knew to be called Elekute, I never knew how the name Elekute sticks with him till date.

We were assembled into different classes and I was in Form 1A. Then I was in class with the likes of Tumbi Ashaye, Tolu Adigun, Olugbodi Kayode who became our first class captain, Akeem Kazeem the second class captain, Femi Oluyemi, Adesuyi Olusegun, Bolarin Lanre, Balogun Sunday, Abass Omotayo (No 1 guy of our set at all times), the troublesome Olagbaju Lanre, Owoade Taiwo and Oyebade Ademola (Crook) just to mention a few. The last two boys I mentioned had their seats at the back; the class shook when the two of them fought at one time.

The name of our first Class Teacher was Mrs. Olaniyan, thereafter Mrs. Abidogun (later known as Mrs. Oladele) who taught us English Language and Literature took over. She was very strict and stern. One of the teachers who took us then was one pretty young lady Miss. Oguntoye (Yoruba teacher). I later learned that she was a daughter of a High Court Judge in Lagos. As small as we were, boys talked about how pretty Miss. Oguntoye was, with the tendency of wanting to date her. God have mercy on us. The only guy that is capable of doing that in our class then was Odunlami Owolabi due to his height. As at Form 2A when small boys like me or Dipo Olatunji are less 3 feet, Odun should not be less than 5 feet such that the Igbo teacher Mazi Ben Okoronkwo called him “o toro ogologo” (he is tall).

There came a time in Form 2A when the whole class was caned. If we had a Courtroom then, we could have hired a lawyer to plead our cause because we did not deserve the beating. Someone (only Lanre Olagbaju or Dipo Olatunji could fit in this situation because they both like sports) brought a transistor radio to class to listen to the Heavyweight Boxing Championship between Mike Tyson and Larry Holmes on BBC World Service sometimes in 1988. Immediately it was announced that Tyson won, we all shouted and there was commotion in the class. It was the Introductory Technology Teacher Mr. Ajao and some other teachers that came to flog us for being unruly. Two months after was Russia 88 and it was the same Mr. Ajao who brought radio and other teachers were now shouting on top of their voice.

There was one Agric. Teacher, whose name was Mr. Adewuni and in our class, a guy named Jide Akande (a.k.a. France) was such an interesting guy, very lively too but he's as well stubborn. Jide cannot cry whenever he's canned by any teacher but the day Mr. Adewuni flogged him for a terrible hairstyle on his head, he cried bitterly with tears and red eyes. Since then, no one never neared the Agric teacher as assignments were done on time.

Another incident happened when we were on cadet training ground. The usual routine whenever one is on ground is to pick 1 or 2. If you picked 1, you go forward and 2 to the back. Adeola Ogungbade came late to the cadet training ground and he was told to fall-in. This is a strange command to a Form 1 boy and he stood unmoved. The Cadet master shouted at him to fall-in and immediately Adeola Ogungbade just fell on the ground in compliance with the instructions. Cadet master could not beat him out of laughter because falling-in on the parade means enter the matching line.

It is wonderful celebrating our 40th anniversary of our admission into GCI. It's been fun all the way.

KOLAWOLE OREJIMI
School No: 6261
Powell House

40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

IMPACT OF THE 1ST GCI CLOSED TABLE TENNIS CHAMPIONSHIP

The 1st Edition of the GCI Closed Table Tennis Championship, organised by the GCI OBA 86/92 Set, was held at Government College Ibadan (GCI) in October 2025. What started as a competitive sporting event among our students has grown into something much bigger—a sporting experience that has left a lasting impression on both the boarding and day students.

The championship was keenly contested, with the organisers and officials putting together what can truly be described as a world-class arrangement. The competition attracted a large audience of students and members of the teaching staff, who turned up to support and cheer their respective sides.

The excitement reached its peak on the final day, as the competition came down to a thrilling battle between the Day Students and Boarding Students. The occasion was further honoured by the presence of the three school principals—the Senior School Principal, Junior School 1 Principal and Junior School 2 Principal — who witnessed the highly competitive final.

At the end of the intense contest, the Day Students emerged as champions, while the Boarding Students finished as runners-up.

However, one of the most memorable stories from the championship was that of the boarding student who finished second. His performance and determination on that day earned him so much admiration from his fellow students that his name was practically changed overnight—from Emmanuel to "LEGEND." And believe me, the name stuck!



THE TENNIS FEVER THAT FOLLOWED

Beyond the trophies and competition, the greatest achievement of the championship may have been the passion for table tennis that it created among the students.among the Day Students and the Boarding Students.

After the competition, table tennis suddenly became the sport everyone wanted to play—both among the Day Students and the Boarding Students.



During break periods, you could see our boys creating their own spaces to play. They played on wooden tables, concrete tables, concrete floors and practically any available space they could turn into a makeshift table tennis court.

The impact was so remarkable that even the woman selling tennis balls around the school noticed the difference.

One day, I asked her jokingly how well she was selling the tennis balls. Her response made me laugh. She said that ever since the table tennis competition was held at GCI, she now sells tennis balls more than biscuits!

And considering that she sells some of the balls at just N200 per piece, you can imagine how much business the competition generated for her.

WE ARE READY FOR THE 2ND EDITION!

For me, this is what makes the championship special. It was not just about winning a trophy or receiving a prize. It inspired our boys, created healthy competition, brought Day and Boarding Students together, and introduced many of them to a sport they have now embraced passionately.

I can categorically say that our boys cannot wait for the 2nd Edition of the GCI Closed Table Tennis Championship. They are ready, motivated and eagerly waiting for another opportunity to represent their respective houses and battle for glory.

My sincere appreciation goes to the GCI OBA 86/92 Set and all the organisers, officials and sponsors who made the 1st Edition such a memorable and successful event.

May God continue to bless the organisers and give them the strength and resources to organise an even bigger and better 2nd Edition.

Long live the GCI OBA 1986 Set!
Long live the organisers!
Long live Government College Ibadan!
And long live the spirit of healthy competition among our boys!

AROLE ADENIYI
GCI Hostel Facility Manager



EMPOWERING THE NEXT GENERATION

GCI 1986 Class set primary mission was clear: to execute projects with direct, meaningful impacts on students and the dedicated staff—both academic and non-academic—who keep our school running.

Our projects are **Empowering the Next Generation:** Through our ICT Project (Project X) and our ICT Summer Camp, we equipped students with vital modern tech skills. We hosted impactful Career Fairs (Supported by Google) to give our pupils the knowledge, direction, and practical skills needed for life after school.

We established recognition programs, awards, and rewards to celebrate the hard work and selfless service of both academic and non-academic staff.

Above all, we brought to life our flagship initiative—the Young Farmers' Club (YFC) & Farm Project—igniting passion and introducing our students to modern agricultural practices.

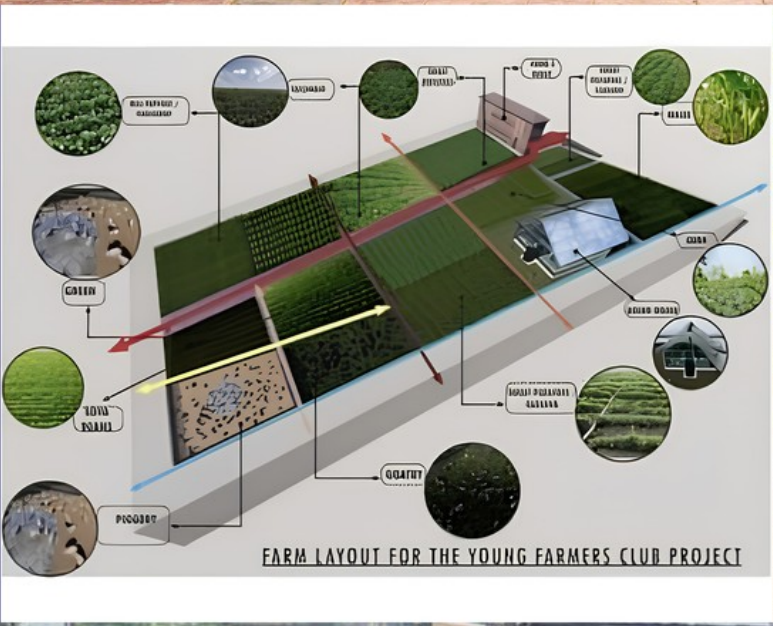
GCIOBA 1986 Class Set raise a glass to 40 years of excellence, friendship, and impact!



40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

PROJECTS





FARM LAYOUT FOR THE YOUNG FARMERS CLUB PROJECT





40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

PROJECTS











40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

FROM VISION TO REALITY: THE YFC PROJECT STORY

Four Years of Growth, Transformation and Impact at Government College Ibadan (2022–2026).

Cultivating the Land, Nurturing Young Minds and Building a Lasting Legacy.

An initiative powered by the Government College Ibadan 1986/1992 Sets.

From Neglected Land to Productive Farmland.

When the Young Farmers Club (YFC) Project commenced at Government College Ibadan in 2022, our vision extended beyond crop cultivation. We sought to establish a practical agricultural learning environment where students could develop skills, gain experience and appreciate the opportunities agriculture offers.

Four years later, that vision has grown into a remarkable journey of transformation, achievements and valuable lessons.

The land initially allocated to us was overgrown with thick vegetation and large trees, providing habitats for snakes, scorpions, rodents and other dangerous animals. Parts had become informal refuse dumps and locations for unauthorised activities. More concerning were broken sections of the school's perimeter fence, which allowed outsiders unrestricted access, posing security risks to students and the wider school community.

Our immediate priority was to reclaim and secure the environment. Through extensive clearing, tree removal and land preparation, we transformed neglected spaces into productive farmland. We repaired damaged perimeter fencing and raised its height where necessary, improving security, visibility and cleanliness.



Our first major achievement came before we planted a single seed.

We also found value in the felled trees. Some wood was supplied to the school kitchen, while other portions were converted into charcoal. Part was donated to the kitchen, and the remainder sold at discounted prices to school staff and community members, demonstrating resourcefulness and practical entrepreneurship.

FROM FIRST HARVESTS TO AGRICULTURAL DIVERSIFICATION

From inception, the project land was divided into two sections: crop production and animal husbandry. We began with maize, our first crop, followed by cassava. Despite pest challenges, both yielded encouraging results.

Our cassava harvest was processed into garri, all of which was donated free of charge to the school kitchen. Students also visited garri and fufu processing facilities in Ibadan, gaining firsthand exposure to agricultural processing and value addition.



In 2025, responding to rising food prices and the school's feeding requirements, we expanded into vegetable production. Our aim was to support the school kitchen while building a financially sustainable agricultural enterprise.

With assistance from the school's Asset Management Committee, we improved the farm layout, constructed a borehole, installed irrigation infrastructure and renovated accommodation for permanent farm workers.

Today, our diversified farm accommodates approximately 1,800 pineapple suckers, over 1,500 plantain stands, thousands of tomato and pepper plants, alongside cassava, maize, okra, fluted pumpkin (ugwu), sweet potatoes, groundnuts and other crops. Cultivation continues to expand as resources permit.

We have successfully harvested tomatoes, peppers and okra, including supplying tomatoes and peppers for the school's 2026 Valedictory Service, an achievement of particular significance.

Fresh produce is regularly supplied to the school kitchen at discounted prices, helping reduce procurement costs. Teachers, non-teaching staff, school residents and local traders also benefit from access to our farm products.





BEYOND FARMING: EDUCATING AND INSPIRING OUR BOYS

The YFC Project's greatest value lies not only in agricultural production but in the knowledge and practical experience it offers students.

Our boys gain exposure to land preparation, nursery establishment, irrigation, planting, harvesting and processing, connecting classroom learning with agricultural practice.

We have organised educational excursions to institutions including the International Institute of Tropical Agriculture (IITA), Ibadan, exposing students to agricultural research, innovation and modern farming techniques.

Experts from the Forestry Research Institute of Nigeria (FRIN) and the National Horticultural Research Institute (NIHORT) have also been invited to deliver educational lectures.

groundnuts, while soil erosion caused by the land's topography continues to demand improved drainage and land management.

Security concerns persist, including vandalism and theft of sections of our galvanised perimeter fencing, requiring repeated repairs and additional protective measures.

A particularly significant challenge is the complete absence of an electricity connection or supply point at the farm. We depend entirely on fuel-powered generators and pumping equipment for operational energy, especially irrigation and water supply. Fuel expenses, rising agricultural input costs and infrastructure development continue to place substantial pressure on our finances.

The presence of snakes and other potentially dangerous animals also remains a concern because of the farm's proximity to classrooms. Nevertheless, sustained clearing, cultivation, fencing and maintenance have reduced dense vegetation, improved visibility and contributed to a cleaner, safer environment.

These experiences have reinforced the importance of resilience, careful planning, adaptability and perseverance. They remind us that agricultural development demands patience, commitment and continuous improvement.

LOOKING AHEAD: BUILDING A SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURAL LEGACY

Our immediate priorities include expanding crop and vegetable production, improving irrigation, managing erosion and pests, strengthening security and developing animal husbandry.

We also intend to explore sustainable energy alternatives to reduce dependence on fuel-powered equipment and improve operational efficiency.

Equally important is strengthening partnerships with agricultural research institutions, the school and our host community to create more opportunities for practical learning, employment and entrepreneurship.

Our long-term ambition is to establish a sustainable agricultural learning centre that will benefit successive generations of Government College Ibadan students while making a meaningful contribution to the wider community.

APPRECIATION: A COLLECTIVE ACHIEVEMENT

We sincerely appreciate the Government College Ibadan Old Boys' Association (GCIOBA) for its enduring commitment to our alma mater.

Special recognition goes to the YFC Project Team, particularly our Project Coordinator, Mr Nofiu Shoremekun, the Executive Committee (EXCO) and the entire 1986/1992 Sets for their financial contributions, expertise, dedication and unwavering support.

We also extend special appreciation to Mr Ojewale Olayemi, Mr Jide Oyeniyi and Mr Johnpaul, as well as Mrs Babalola, Mrs Mabawonku and Mr Ajala of the Agricultural Science Department, for their invaluable contributions.

Our gratitude extends to current and former Principals and Vice-Principals, past and present Agricultural Science teachers, including those recently transferred, school management and staff, the Asset Management Committee and its Chairman, Mr Shonola, Mr Okeleke, farm workers, technical partners and our host community.

We welcome continued support from GCIOBA, our sets, the school, government, fellow alumni, corporate organisations and well-meaning individuals as we work to sustain and expand this initiative.

CONCLUSION: BUILT ON THE ROCK, GROWING TOWARDS THE FUTURE

Reflecting on our journey from 2022 to 2026, we are proud of our progress while recognising that much remains to be achieved.

What began as the reclamation of neglected land has evolved into an agricultural initiative advancing education, food production, environmental improvement, school welfare and community development.

Regular agricultural pep talks and interactive sessions cover crop production, rabbitry, animal husbandry and entrepreneurship.

Having adopted and supported the school's Agricultural Science Department, we have sponsored quiz competitions and awarded prizes to deserving students, encouraging academic excellence and greater interest in agriculture.

Through these initiatives, students are discovering agriculture as a field of science, technology, innovation and enterprise, rather than merely manual labour.

Our greatest harvest may ultimately be the knowledge, skills, confidence and opportunities we cultivate in our boys.



ANIMAL HUSBANDRY AND FARM SECURITY

A significant milestone has been the development of approximately two plots dedicated to animal husbandry.

We have constructed and reinforced perimeter fencing, installed solar-powered security lighting and deployed six solar-powered CCTV units: four covering crop-production areas, including vegetables and plantains, and two covering the animal husbandry section.

These investments help protect the farm while improving security within the wider school environment.

These investments help protect the farm while improving security within the wider school environment.

We have also constructed a rabbit pen with nine cage compartments, currently housing approximately 100 rabbits, with further growth anticipated through breeding.

Our future plans include introducing goats, rams, cattle, grasscutters and other suitable livestock. Besides providing practical livestock-management experience, we envisage eventually supplying fresh meat to the school kitchen and boarding house, contributing to students' nutritional needs.

SUPPORTING THE SCHOOL AND OUR HOST COMMUNITY

Our commitment extends beyond farming to supporting the school and strengthening relationships with our host community.

Through donations of garri and charcoal, discounted vegetables and other agricultural produce, we have contributed to the school's feeding programme and general welfare. The farm's borehole also provides drinking water for students who regularly visit.

We have engaged local residents as daily-paid workers, purchased supplies from community businesses and made farm produce available to local traders.

By sourcing produce closer to home, traders can reduce journeys to distant farms, while our activities support local livelihoods and encourage positive community relations.

We measure success not simply by our harvests but by the difference we make to the school, its students and the surrounding community.

CHALLENGES, LESSONS AND ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT

Our achievements have come despite considerable challenges.

Recruiting and retaining reliable farm workers remains difficult. Rodents and other pests have repeatedly damaged crops, particularly maize and

Our journey embodies the enduring spirit of Government College Ibadan, proudly celebrated as “School of Our Pride, Built on the Rock.” Just as our alma mater stands firmly on the rocky terrain of Apata, the YFC Project rests on determination, resilience, shared responsibility and the collective commitment of the 1986/1992 Sets.

We have faced challenges, celebrated achievements and learned valuable lessons. Above all, we have continued opening our boys' minds to the possibilities of agriculture.

We started by clearing the land. We progressed to planting seeds. Today, we are cultivating knowledge, building skills, creating opportunities and laying the foundation for a lasting legacy.

And perhaps our most important harvest is still ahead of us.

WALE ADESIPE (ROTOR)
Project Manager,
on behalf of the YFC Project Team
Government College Ibadan 1986/1992 Sets
October 2026



40th ANNIVERSARY REUNION

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